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EXECUTIVE PITCH BRIEF

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Huntress

Principal Software Engineer, SOC Experience (Ruby/Rails)

Candidate: Mike Hall ([Just3Ws](#)) · Principal Software Engineer

Target Role: Principal Software Engineer, SOC Experience (Ruby/Rails)

Company: Huntress (Remote, US)

Core Domain: High-Concurrency Ruby on Rails Architecture, SOC Telemetry, Distributed Systems, Legacy De-risking

Executive Summary & Mandate Alignment

Huntress's mission: **scaling high-concurrency Ruby on Rails platforms that power 24/7 Security Operations Center (SOC) detection, investigation, and incident response:** matches my 20+ year track record stabilizing high-consequence monoliths, deploying distributed OpenTelemetry, and isolating critical failure modes under live load.

I bring calm, deterministic systems leadership to teams where platform reliability directly impacts threat detection and security operations.

Direct Architectural Match & Evidence

1. High-Consequence Rails Monolith Architecture & Modernization

- **Acquisition Lane Architecture (OneMain Financial):** Appointed Software Architect for an acquisition engine processing hundreds of millions in financial throughput. Mapped seven heterogeneous ingress channels, refactored multi-step Rails state machines, and decoupled service boundaries between Acquisition and Originations.
- **Database Archaeology & Safety:** Architected an automated 5-phase PII remediation deletion engine across 30+ tables, safely purging legacy orphan records under production traffic without table locks.
- **Craftsmanship Foundations:** 20+ years of production Ruby on Rails expertise (2.x through 8.x), strict TDD discipline, and relational data modeling in PostgreSQL.

2. Deep Observability, Distributed Tracing & Incident Command

- **Enterprise Trace Deployment:** Led the enterprise OpenTelemetry deployment across distributed Rails services, MuleSoft APIs, and Mainframe backends. Standardized W3C trace context headers to bridge siloed logs into causal event chains.
- **Eliminating Silent Outages:** Diagnosed and eliminated a persistent CookieOverflow defect that silently dropped 4% of digital loan applications during offer selection and e-signing, implementing custom rescue middleware and migrating Rails session storage to AWS DynamoDB.
- **Community Enablement:** Founded Geekfest@OMF and the weekly OpenTelemetry Working Group, scaling cross-lane participation to 40+ engineers before transitioning ongoing facilitation sustainably to SRE.

3. Cyber & Fraud Detection Systems

- **Fraud & Anomaly Analytics (Groupon):** Designed analytical fraud detection queries in Vertica, analyzed merchant transaction risk, and conducted exploratory anomaly detection spikes in Hadoop and Clojure.
- **Edge Telemetry & Scrubbing ([Agent Tooling](#) / [wwworkremote](#)):** Built OTel telemetry ingestion pipelines with automated PII-scrubbing at the collector edge, enabling safe root-cause diagnosis for security investigations.

30-Second Interview Calibration (The “Answer, Frame, and Pause” Rule)

“I specialize in high-consequence Ruby on Rails platforms where uptime, data integrity, and deep observability are non-negotiable. At OneMain Financial, I led the Acquisition architecture: mapping seven ingress channels, eliminating a 4% silent traffic drop via DynamoDB session remediation, and safely

purging legacy PII across 30+ database tables. Huntress protects organizations against real-world adversaries, and I bring the platform resilience and telemetry discipline required to keep SOC analysts fast and systems unbreakable.”

(Pause & Hook): “I can dive deeper into how we migrated Rails session storage to DynamoDB, or we can look at the 5-phase database deletion engine. Which direction would you prefer to explore?”



Authoritative Verification Links

- **System Cartography Essay:** just3ws.com/2026/08/29/system-cartography-how-to-map-a-ten-year-old-monolith/
- **Portfolio & Case Studies:** just3ws.com/case-studies/
- **Canonical Résumé:** just3ws.com/resume
- **GitHub Profile:** github.com/just3ws



Direct Outreach & Referral Copy (Playbook)

[View Playbook Protocol →](#)

Pre-calibrated 75-word messages linking directly to this 1-page brief. Follows the *high-signal peer value* rule with zero calendar begging.

Cold Hiring Manager

Warm Peer / Referral

Subject: Principal Engineer note: Rails, distributed scale & platform res

Copy Text

Hi [Name],

I saw Huntress is scaling Principal Software Engineer, SOC Experience (Ruby/Rails) and looking for a Principal Software Engineer.

I specialize in high-consequence Ruby on Rails platforms and legacy modernization. Over the past several years, I served as Acquisition Lane Architect at OneMain Financial, decoupling lending funnels, eliminating a 4% silent transaction drop, and driving enterprise OpenTelemetry adoption across Rails and middleware tiers.

I put together a focused 1-page technical brief mapping my background to your current engineering challenges:

👉 <https://www.just3ws.com/exports/briefs/huntress-principal-software-engineer-soc-experience-ruby-rails/>

If this aligns with what you need on the team, I would be glad to compare notes. If timing is off, no need to reply.

Best,
Mike Hall
<https://just3ws.com>